

Do AI tools like ChatGPT and DeepSeek or Blackbox AI etc. still consume large amounts of water per response?

Posted by u/Sad_Butterscotch7063 • • 0 points • 4 comments

Hey everyone,

I recently came across some articles saying that AI models like ChatGPT, DeepSeek, and Blackbox AI reportedly use a surprising amount of water to generate responses, mainly for cooling the massive data centers they run on. That really got me thinking about the environmental cost of using these tools, especially as they become more integrated into daily life.

Has there been any update on whether companies have taken steps to reduce or moderate water usage because of these concerns? Are there any public efforts or transparency reports about sustainable practices in AI infrastructure?

Would love to hear if anyone here has looked into this!

Comments

u/boredirl • 1 points • 2025-04-08 18:02 UTC

I've never once had to water my chatgpt

u/TangibleSounds • 1 points • 2025-04-07 14:12 UTC

AI computation is extremely energy intensive (which is why the cost of AI will skyrocket in a few years once the VC money subsidizing everything dries up) and that energy goes into running GPUs which need a ton of cooling. I'm not totally clear on why the cooling requires new water to use, unlike liquid cooling systems that people have in their desktop PC gaming rigs

u/PuzzleheadedYou4992 • 1 points • 2025-04-06 02:11 UTC

Yeah, I saw that too. It's wild how much water they use. Hope they find a way to make it more sustainable.

u/Shanus_Zeeshu • 2 points • 2025-04-05 14:38 UTC

AI tools like ChatGPT, DeepSeek, and Blackbox AI do consume water, mainly for cooling data centers. It's estimated that generating a 100-word response can use around 5 milliliters of water.

Companies are addressing this with more sustainable practices. For instance, Microsoft launched data centers with zero water usage for cooling, and liquid cooling systems are becoming more common to reduce water and energy consumption.

As AI grows, efforts are being made to make it more environmentally friendly.

u/Ausbel12 • 2 points • 2025-04-05 20:29 UTC

Damn didn't know they consume that much. And to think having Blackbox AI create me a survey app contributed something to that is yikes lol

u/HawkingRadiation_ • 12 points • 2025-04-05 11:58 UTC

[recent video that's relevant](<https://youtu.be/5sFBySzNIX0?si=pQiaP06SSAYtHweY>).

I have less of an issue of *people* using AI to learn about a topic, or help them write code, and more of an issue with things like businesses and corporations that use AI to generate useless slop hundreds of thousands of times per day rather than just paying an actual human being to do work for them. Same with AI ad agencies which just churn out AI generated photos to sell of by the millions.